

Orkut has had its fair share of controversies. It has been banned in Saudi Arabia and Iran. In India Orkut has been the target of political parties like the Shiv Sena and has also come under the scrutiny of the courts for featuring anti-India communities. In Brazil charges of propagation of racism by users have hit the portal. In the area of security the site is vulnerable to cross scripting attacks, phishing attacks, malware and viruses. As of writing this, Orkut still has unfixed vulnerabilities regarding session management and authentication. These vulnerabilities could prove fatal if Orkut is used through cybercafés because sessions remain active even 24 hours after logging out and they can be hijacked. Bad news for most Indians, but it does not look like Orkut is getting any less popular.

## 2.3 [www.facebook.com](http://www.facebook.com)

---

The leader in social networking space until MySpace usurped that position, Facebook was originally established as an exclusive social networking site for college students. Only members with valid college or



university e-mail IDs could join the network, though it is now available to anybody with a valid e-mail address. It remains the most popular site for college students, with over 25 million out of a total of 28 million Facebook members worldwide still in college.

Founded in February 2004 by Mark Zuckerberg from Harvard University, it quickly captured the imagination of the campus populations who wanted an exclusive place of their own. Membership within a year ballooned to almost a million with almost all colleges and universities in the US having a presence. Soon a high school version was introduced where students from high schools and junior colleges could be invited in. In September 2006